

When it comes to time spent developing presentation content, the first problem is one of organising the information. What comes first? How do I present my various topics? In what order? One method by which you can structure your presentations is:

- **Introduction:** Usually the title slide, with perhaps a sub-title and pertinent information like the name of the author.
- **Agenda:** An overview of what you are going to present. Also, you could indicate the time the presentation will take—if you have rehearsed your presentation well. You could also include the timing of individual segments
- **Body:** Depending on the topic and depth of coverage, you might want to split this into multiple parts
- **Conclusion:** Summarising what you presented, highlighting important points, and next steps if any.

Once you've given it some thought and organised your ideas, the next step is to start putting it down. This is where the outlining feature enables you to leapfrog your productivity.

8.1 Outlining Commands

The fastest way to get the content of your presentation into PowerPoint is to work on it in outlining mode. Normally, you would create the content of your presentation by working on it slide by slide, flipping back and forth between the slides when you need to change something. This can be distracting—not to speak about the other distractions of wanting to tweak the layout and design to accommodate the content.

By working in outlining mode, you eliminate most of these distractions. You can just focus on the flow of ideas, rearranging, editing, or deleting the text as needed. Some pundits advise that you just pump in your ideas as they occur to you without regard to logically structuring your presentation. This way you capture